

The AshenSpire Workbench

One project. Familiar controls. Different work surfaces. The workbench frames the game without imitating its HUD.

ASHENSPIRE

Project: AshenSpire / dev @ 38166cb

Find anything Ctrl K

Review changes

Export

CONTENT

Cards

Decks

Tags / ERD

PRESENTATION

Scenes

Battlefield

UI settings

Poses & effects

TEST

Combat workshop

PROJECT

Project tools

LIBRARY

Search this library...

Cards in project

Ambush
rogue / starter

Quick Cut
rogue / common

Feint
rogue / common

Backstep
rogue / common

Ambush / card definition

Visual / Table / Form / JSON / Prompt

Select Move Align Grid: on Snap: on

CARD PREVIEW / TEXT-ONLY WIREFRAME

Ambush

ROGUE / ATTACK

Deal 5 damage.

Prepared: deal 8 more.

Apply 1 Vulnerable.

Consume Prepared.

Action 1 / Stamina 1 / Mana 1

id: ambush

Same ID in every mode

No mock artwork or invented game effects

INSPECTOR

Selection / Document

Ambush

IDENTITY

ambush / immutable reference

AUTHORING

Mechanics and presentation are separate sections.

PROVENANCE

From src/content/cards/rogue.js

PREVIEW

Draft presentation. Engine outcome untested.

Draft recovered locally | Source unchanged

Draft renderer | Not applied to game

Motif

Charcoal tools, warm paper content, ember gold selection. Square structure with 4-8 px corner radii. The visual spire is a thin rising rule, not ornamental chrome.

Visual hierarchy

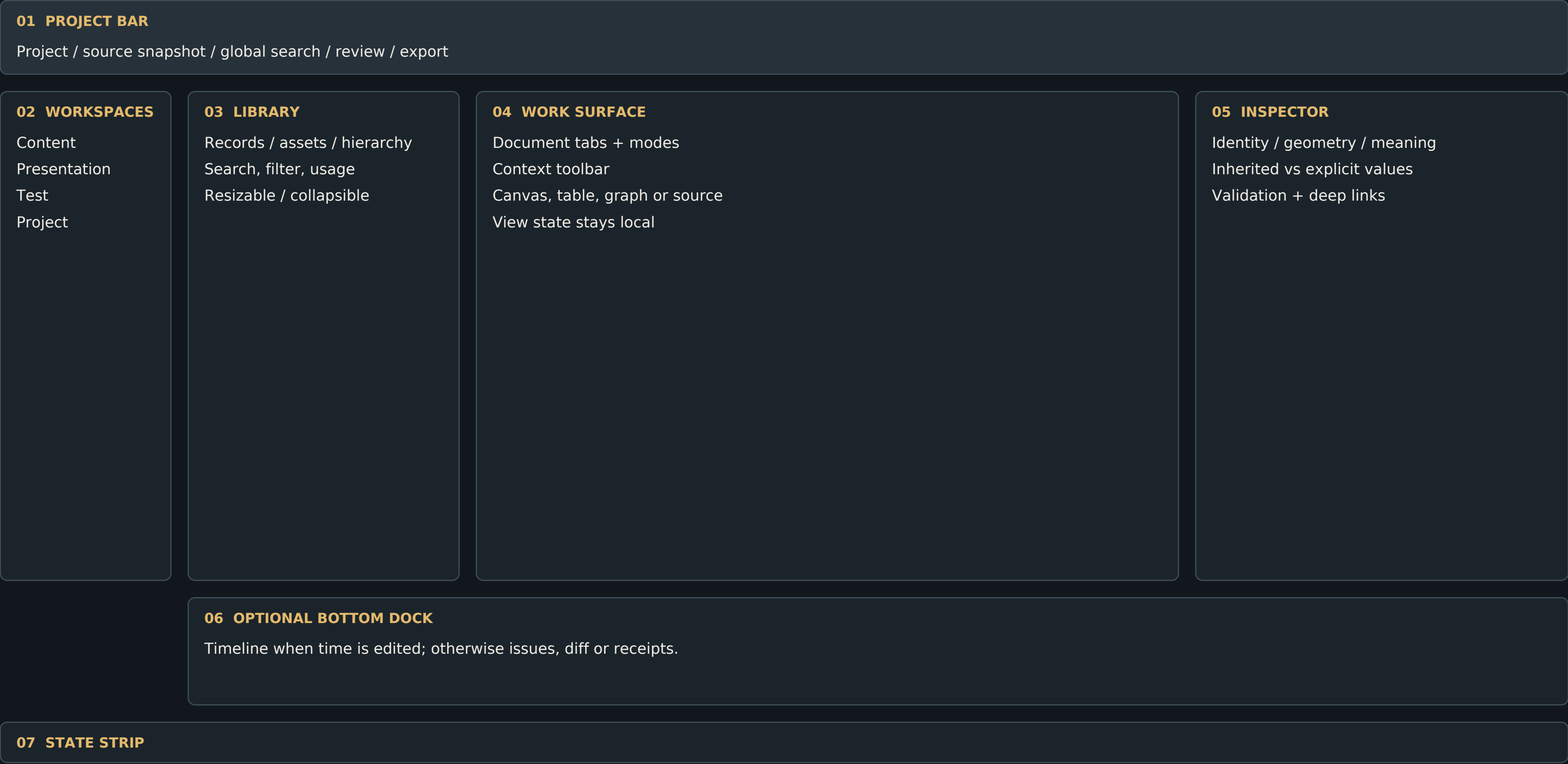
Neutral workspace chrome lets art and rules lead. Gold means selected or primary. Status always includes a word; color never carries meaning alone.

Baseline

This book supersedes the earlier parent-shell and ERD assumptions. ERD target is Workbench 0.2.4; native file version remains 3. All screens here are proposals.

Parent anatomy and motif tokens

A stable frame supports canvas work, source editing, relation mapping and deterministic tests.



Palette

Canvas #11171C; panels #1B242B; raised #26313A; text #F1EEE7; muted #B5C0C7; gold #E4BA6C; paper #EDE6D6. Warm light reading surfaces are optional.

Spacing and type

4 px base; 8/12/16/24/32 spacing. App text 14 px, labels 12 px, titles 18-24 px; Mono for IDs and exact values. Desktop fields 32 px, touch targets at least 44 px.

Panel rules

Desktop: rail + library + surface + inspector. Tablet: one docked side panel. Phone: one surface with Library / Selection / Preview sheets. Target viewport is independent of editor width.

Card Studio: one card, five views

Select Ambush, edit presentation, inspect the source diff, and carry the same document into another mode.

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Assets / Layers

Rules text

selected layer

Name

inherited style

Frame

template reference

Art source

original retained

Cost icons

renderer owned

Ambush / presentation draft

Visual / Table / Form / JSON / Prompt

Select Crop Align Grid Snap State: normal

Ambush

ROGUE / ATTACK

Deal 5 damage.

Prepared: deal 8 more.

Apply 1 Vulnerable.

Consume Prepared.

Action 1 / Stamina 1 / Mana 1

id: ambush

PREVIEW SURFACES

Glance

Resolved field policy

Focus

Resolved field policy

Inspect

Resolved field policy

INSPECTOR

Selection / Document

Rules text

FIELD VISIBILITY

glance subset focus subset inspect

EXACT VALUE

Font size / unit / min / max / reset

INHERITANCE

Template default -> surface override

CAPABILITY

Unsupported free-form layout stays editor-only.

Draft recovered locally | Source unchanged

Draft renderer | Not applied to game

Improvement

One selection and one history across Visual, Table, Form, JSON and Prompt. Readable complete rules; source IDs remain visible. Layers and presets reuse the renderer schema.

Preview example

Ambush uses source values: 5 damage, +8 when Prepared, 1 Vulnerable, then remove Prepared. Text-only composition shows semantics without pretending to reproduce current card art.

Gap closed

Prompt returns a proposal diff, not an applied change. Invalid source keeps last valid preview. Crop and masks retain original art; unsupported renderer fields cannot silently export.

Decks: inspect first, move explicitly

Collection and deck stay visible together. A click reads a card; Add and Remove change deck contents.

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Filters

Class: Rogue

illustrative filter state

Type: any

attack / skill

Cost: any

exact resource cost

Source: any

equipment / reward

Upgraded: any

definition variant

Rogue / deck session

Collection / Deck / Validation

Search cards Filters Sort: name Add selected Remove copy

CARD

Ambush

Inspect

Quick Cut

Inspect

Feint

Inspect

Backstep

Inspect

DECK / SAMPLE SESSION

CARD

Ambush

Copies

1

Backstep

1

Equipment card

Locked

Add selected

Remove selected

VALIDATION USES EXISTING DECK RULES

Show actual min/max, copy bounds and ownership refusals from the model. No invented universal deck size.

INSPECTOR

Selection / Document

Ambush

INSPECTION

Full rules and resource costs. Opening this never adds a copy.

CONTEXT

Open Card Studio / Tags / Animation

ORDER

Reordering enabled only in ordered-play mode.

SESSION

Confirm commits; Cancel restores original deck.

Draft recovered locally | Source unchanged

Draft renderer | Not applied to game

Improvement

Large pinned inspection, explicit add/remove, visible drop targets and exact refusal reasons. Existing model remains authoritative for copy limits and equipment-granted cards.

Gesture contract

Mouse, touch hold and keyboard Move share one command. Escape, pointer cancel, invalid target and lost capture restore the pre-move state. One move is one undo.

Preview example

Inspect Ambush -> Add selected -> validate -> Confirm. An equipment card shows its owner and why removal is refused. Sample copy counts above are illustrative.

Tags and ERD: meaning beside structure

One record selection can appear in table, parent tree, relationship diagram and source views.

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Authoring owners

nodes.csv
IDs / parentId

tagging.csv
scoped assignments

familyNodes.csv
allowed associations

nodeEffects.json
mechanic definitions

nodeRelations.csv
explicit relations

Tag authoring / project nodes

Table / Tree / ERD 0.2.4 / Mermaid / JSON

Select Connect Parent move Fit Import records Usage

nodes

id PK
parentId -> nodes.id
label / domain

nodeEffects

nodeId -> nodes.id
approved definition
runtime reader

assigns

tagging

family / scope
objectId
tagId -> nodes.id

familyNodes

family
nodeId -> nodes.id
legal ancestry

Conceptual authoring relationship map; not a database migration.

INSPECTOR

Selection / Document

nodes / stable IDs

PARENT

parentId is hierarchy. Dotted names are opaque IDs.

EFFECT

A label does not grant a mechanic. Inspect the actual definition.

USAGE

Family + scope + objectId required.

POINTS

Advisory estimate; no implied runtime budget.

Draft recovered locally | Source unchanged

Draft renderer | Not applied to game

Improvement

Cross-highlight record and diagram. Inspect explicit vs inherited membership, effect support, dependencies and usage. Reparent through cycle-checked Move under, with drag as an alternative.

ERD baseline

Keep Workbench 0.2.4 pages, nodes, fields, edges, Mermaid, tests, query and history. App version 0.2.4 differs from native project version 3. Accept native v2/v3 through explicit adapters.

Gap closed

Diagram IDs never become gameplay IDs by accident. Tree, association and mechanic readers stay separate. No new feat family or arbitrary card property mount is assumed.

ERD 0.2.4: choose, map, complete, review

Native projects can contain imported data. Mermaid or schema-only diagrams supply structure, not record values.

1 / SOURCE

Native .erd.json / Mermaid / schema

App 0.2.4 / native version 3

Choose page explicitly

Keep original bytes and digest

2 / SEMANTICS

Entity -> target authoring owner

Field -> ID / parent / reference

Diagram identity != game identity

Choose supplied rows or companion data

3 / REVIEW

New / changed / unchanged records

Missing required values

Cycles / duplicate IDs / dangling refs

Unsupported fields and conflicts

MAPPING PREVIEW / ILLUSTRATIVE IMPORT			
Source	Target	Record source	Decision
page: Tag model	nodes.csv	Imported rows present	Validate every required field
Tag.id	nodes.id	Supplied values	Match existing stable IDs
Tag.parent	nodes.parentId	Supplied values	Check ancestry and cycles
CardTag	tagging.csv	No supplied records	Companion rows required
Drawing note	Editor annotations	No gameplay effect	Retain outside game export
Review proposal Apply records: blocked		Blocked until required values and conflicts resolve.	

Lossless boundary

Keep raw native project alongside mapping metadata. 0.2.4 exports per-page Mermaid, but page validation rebuilds nodes/edges/data; preserve raw source rather than assuming all fields survive its loader.

Data provenance

Exported project data retains mode=imported rows. Generated sample rows are not promoted to real game records. Show page, entity, origin and supplied-row count before semantic mapping.

Acceptance

Schema-only import creates zero game records. Imported rows need legal IDs and scopes. Block oversized inputs before truncation: native limits include 40 pages, 500 nodes and 1,000 edges per page.

Scenes: compose outside the live game

Reuse the actual prologue renderer and existing settings through a host adapter; add new composition capabilities visibly.

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LIBRARY

Search this library...

Scene / Layers

Selected scene
stable scene ID

Background
focus + crop

Traveller
body + shadow semantics

Words
name / speaker / text

Audio
music / stinger

Opening / selected scene

Sample draft

Compose / Words & sound / Compare / JSON

Select Move traveller Background focus Grid Snap Device: desktop

SCENE GEOMETRY / NO MOCK ART

Traveller
bounds

Foot anchor / shadow remains a separate renderer concern

Speaker / opening words / readable text region

TIMELINE / ILLUSTRATIVE CUE POSITIONS

Camera

Text reveal

Music

INSPECTOR

Selection / Document

Traveller placement

MODE

Automatic / Locked automatic / Manual

BACKGROUND

Anchor preset tied to background ID.

GEOMETRY

Exact x / y / scale. Added rotation requires renderer support.

CURRENT SETTINGS

Art, words, camera, reveal, audio, duration and waits remain available.

Draft recovered locally | Source unchanged

Draft scene renderer | Not applied to game

Improvement

Scene list, layers, canvas and timing stay together. Background changes use saved anchor presets. Locked automatic keeps solved coordinates and exposes a background mismatch.

Preview example

Choose background -> inspect focus -> place traveller -> scrub text reveal -> compare device sizes. Current scene enablement, slot rules and stable ID migration are preserved.

Gap closed

External host acknowledges applied revision. Multi-sprite layers are a capability extension; disabled controls explain required support. Existing shadow scaling is preserved, not replaced by one bounding box.

Battlefield Lab: cards and field first

An isolated layout proposal. Initial composition keeps only the battlefield and card region inside editor chrome.

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Components

Battlefield
viewport bounds

Card region
independent size

Formation preset
later sizing diagnostics

Device presets
desktop / tablet / phone

Layers
lock / group / order

Battlefield / isolated proposal

Sample draft

Layout / Sizing diagnostics / Compare / JSON

Select Resize Align Grid Snap Target: 1440 x 900

BATTLEFIELD

Viewport boundary and formation guides

CARD REGION

Card

Card

Card

Card

Card

INSPECTOR

Selection / Document

Sizing policy

SPRITE BASE

40% of battlefield stage height

ROLE / SELECTION

Boss 2x / selected 1.5x -> 120% stage height

DEFAULT

Show overflow; never silently clamp.

PROPOSAL EXPORT

Separate sprite/card base and selected sizes. No live Apply command.

Draft recovered locally | Source unchanged

Lab proposal | Not applied to game

Improvement

Make units explicit: percent of battlefield stage, not browser height. Body bounds, alpha bounds and shadow bounds are separately reported in later diagnostics.

Gap closed

40% x 2 x 1.5 = 120%. Choose overflow, fit formation, cap selected or spacing adjustment explicitly. Exactly one selected character receives the top selection layer.

Boundary

This layout page contains field and cards only. Sprite tests belong in Sizing diagnostics. Export proposal JSON with source digest; live game layout remains untouched.

UI settings: exact values with visible inheritance

Config and sketch share inspection patterns, while preserving their different compiler capabilities.

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Config tree

sizingexact units

positioninganchors / inset

layeringz-order / unique IDs

motionlegal references

behaviorfield visibility

Combat layout / authored config

Config / Sketch / Compare / Saved build

Devices Rotate Custom size Show bounds Reset view

DEVICE CONTACT SHEET / SCHEMATIC

Desktop

Field

Tablet

Field

Phone

Field

Compare mode is read-only

Config draft / sketch draft / saved build stay distinctly labelled.

INSPECTOR

Selection / Document

Selected value

AUTHORING SOURCE

File path + JSON pointer + unit

PROVENANCE

Explicit override / local variable / token

EDIT

Minus / slider / field / plus / Reset

LIMIT

Breakpoint geometry exists for sketches; arbitrary config overrides need compiler support.

Draft recovered locally | Source unchanged

Config draft | Not applied to game

Improvement

Search by path, filter changed values, preserve variables and fractions, pair slider with text field and arrows. Reset removes an override instead of copying its resolved number.

Preview example

Adjust a band edge -> neighbor absorbs slack -> total remains 100 -> validate with config compiler -> review one-line diff -> save and compile -> view labelled saved build.

Gap closed

Editor screen size is independent of target device size. Existing game layout modes and zoom are preserved. Clamp overlays report authored and measured values separately.

Poses and effects: time, attachment and match reasons

Stage, pose strip, effects and binding inspector share one selection. Format capabilities remain explicit.

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Assets / Effects

Pose sequence

uniform sampling today

Imported PNG / WebP

original retained

Effect clip

cue / offset / duration

Anchors

body / attachment

Missing assets

repair references

Ambush / presentation binding

Stage / Bindings / Dependencies / JSON

Sample draft

Play Scrub Speed: 1x Loop Reduced motion Fit

STAGE / ASSET BOUNDS

Pose asset

TIMELINE / SECONDS

Poses

Front effect

Behind effect

INSPECTOR

Selection / Document

Binding / ambush

MATCH

provider / kind / objectId / event / tags / actual payment

PRIORITY

Equal winning priority is a conflict, not a random pick.

TIMING

Cue + offset + duration with units.

FORMAT

Presentation schema v1. Desktop pose package is a separate adapter.

Draft recovered locally | Source unchanged

Local presentation draft | Not applied to game

Improvement

Scrub, trim, front/behind/aura, exact transforms and binding match reasons stay visible. Card deep links edit binding without replacing the animation project.

Preview example

Open Ambush binding -> choose supported event -> scrub effect -> inspect dependency/fallback -> export presentation project. A game bridge must acknowledge a deduplicated applied revision.

Gap closed

Current presentation poses are sampled uniformly across sequence duration. Per-pose timing, sprite slicing and onion skins require supported adapters; no silently dropped controls.

DESIGN PROPOSAL / STATIC WIREFRAMES / 29 SEP 2026 / SAMPLE STATES ARE NOT ENGINE RESULTS

10

Combat Workshop: a test bench with receipts

Author a deterministic fixture, identify the engine and ruleset, then compare baseline and candidate.

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Fixtures

Ambush opening
sample scenario

Prepared variant
same seed and build

Resource refusal
atomic failure case

Draw / temporary cards
lifecycle verification

Enemy lineup
registered IDs only

Ambush / regression scenario

Scenario / Run / Compare / Receipts

Validate Load scenario Step Restart seed Baseline compare

ENGINE NOT CONNECTED

Run disabled until identity handshake

Ruleset

Choose legacy or foundations

Seed

Illustrative fixed seed

Side	Setup	Expected check
Player	Registered deck / resources	Payment verified
Enemy	Registered fixture IDs	Damage / target state
Card	ambush	Prepared conditional branch
Variant	Prepared status present	Extra effect then removal

NO MOCK RESULTS / RECEIPTS APPEAR AFTER REAL EXECUTION

INSPECTOR

Selection / Document

Runner identity

ENGINE

Snapshot commit + content digest required.

RULESET

Legacy and foundations remain separate.

APPLIED STATE

Scenario digest + revision acknowledgement.

RESULTS

Resources / piles / statuses / RNG / event receipts and diffs.

Draft recovered locally | Source unchanged

Scenario draft | Not applied to game

Improvement

Scenario input, real state, restart, step and baseline diff form one flow. Receipt links explain payments, recipients, triggered effects and temporary card lifecycle.

Preview example

Baseline Ambush vs Prepared variant uses same build and seed. Check +8 conditional damage and Prepared removal through actual engine receipts; no result is asserted by this wireframe.

Source gap

Standalone Workshop repository remains inaccessible in this session. Preserve its engine snapshot once available. Simplified or disconnected previews are visibly labelled and cannot claim engine application.

Project tools: common services, separate owners

Assets, tables, scripts, plugins, prompts, history and export complete the parent workbench.

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Find anything Ctrl K

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Project sections

Pending changes
authored owners only

Assets
references / original files

CSV / JSON / Forms
same document adapter

Scripts / Plugins
local tool context

Build / History
compiler / backups

Project / review changes

Sample draft

Assets / Tables / Scripts / Plugins / History

Validate selected Inspect dependencies Stage restore Build Export package

Owner	Change	Status
Card definition	ambush presentation	Draft
nodes.csv	Tag mapping proposal	Unapplied
UI sketch	Battlefield sizing	Lab only
Presentation project	Binding revision	Draft
Generated modules	Compiler output	No direct edit

SAVE TRANSACTION

Review -> validate -> compare expected hashes -> retain backups -> write authored files -> compile -> record build identity.

INSPECTOR

Selection / Document

Change review

CONFLICT
Different on-disk hash blocks
overwrite; compare before rebasing
draft.

RECOVERY
Backups restore as staged edits for
review.

EXPORT
Whole or selected package includes
dependency closure and manifest.

ASSISTANT
Proposals / diff / handoff. No inferred
remote execution.

Draft recovered locally | Source unchanged

Review only | Not applied to game

Improvement

All tools reuse project identity, asset references, search, validators, history and write transactions. Existing standalone entrypoints remain usable; shell does not copy their databases.

Plugins and scripts

Editor HTML plugin support is distinct from engine extensions. Show permissions, compatible host and entrypoint. Script syntax checks are not proof of gameplay correctness.

Gap closed

Missing dependency blocks complete export or is listed in an explicitly incomplete package. Unknown fields remain in native/editor storage; lossy game exports require a surfaced decision.

Three editor sizes, one authoring model

Panel adaptation changes the editor layout; it does not alter the game target or source document.

DESKTOP / 1440+

Project / Document / Status

Nav

Library

Surface

Inspector

TABLET / 800-1199

Project / Document / Status

Surface

Inspector

Library opens as drawer

PHONE / BELOW 800

Project / Document / Status

Editing surface

Selection sheet

Value

40

%

Library / Select / Preview

FOCUS AND TOUCH CONTRACT

Keep a visible close/back action. Restore focus to the object that opened a sheet. Use 44 px touch targets and scrollable panels. Touch drags start from explicit grips; reading and scrolling stay available.

Desktop focus layout

Default 148 px workspace rail, 214 px library and 270 px inspector in this book. Actual panels resize within bounds; collapse them before shrinking the work surface below its useful minimum.

Phone numeric editing

Decimal input uses text-backed editing with inputmode=decimal. Focus places caret at the end unless text is intentionally selected. Pending minus/decimal is preserved until commit; invalid values show an inline issue.

Keyboard and access

Logical tab order: project -> workspace -> library -> surface -> inspector -> dock. Every gesture has a labelled command. Preserve native text shortcuts; menus and drawers return focus after close.

Shared control grammar and preview truth

Same controls, same units, same recovery behavior. Different tool capabilities are explicit.

NUMERIC CONTROL / PROPOSED GRAMMAR

Sprite base height

Explicit override

-

40 %

+

Reset

Min 30% / max 80% / step 1% / percentage of stage height

Reset removes override -> inherited value returns

Bounds shown here come from the requested sizing range.

STATE VOCABULARY

Selected	Gold outline + name
Inherited	Source path + resolved value
Locked	Inspectable, mutation blocked
Conflict	Review before write
Pending	Last valid preview retained

PREVIEW LABELS / THESE STATES ARE NEVER INTERCHANGEABLE

State label	What it means	Required evidence
Draft renderer	Local authoring document	Document revision + adapter identity
Saved build	Compiled saved source	Build commit + content/config digest
Local override	Presentation replacement only	Bridge acknowledgement + applied revision
Engine scenario	Real isolated simulation	Engine snapshot + ruleset + seed + scenario digest
Exported	File/package produced	Manifest + dependency validation; no application implied

Transactions

A completed drag or slider gesture is one undo. Field commit is one command. Mode switches preserve selection. Undo excludes panel widths, zoom, playback speed and other view state.

Empty and failure states

Empty: create/import/choose example. Missing asset: repair reference. Unsupported operation: capability reason. Failed write: draft remains. No handshake: connected actions stay disabled.

Status copy

Use Saved locally, Export complete, Applied revision 12, or Engine not connected. Avoid a generic green success badge that suggests an exported file already changed the game.

Fill the seams before expanding the feature list

These are concrete design decisions. Implementation must prove the adapter contracts against existing tools.

Gap	Decision	Acceptance boundary
Parent ownership	Shared project context; native tool owns its document.	No second card/tag database.
Document modes	Single adapter + revision + command history.	Invalid source preserves last valid state.
Deep links	Project / workspace / document / selection / view.	Missing refs open a repair state.
ERD 0.2.4	Page choice + imported-row provenance + semantic mapping.	Raw native file preserved.
Scene hosting	Extract renderer boundary; exact setting keys preserved.	Host acknowledges revision.
Battlefield fit	Overflow default; fit/cap/spacing explicitly chosen.	No live layout writes.
Pose formats	Presentation and desktop package adapters separate.	Unsupported timing cannot vanish.
Combat bridge	Snapshot + ruleset + seed + scenario acknowledgement.	No simulated result passed off as engine.
Persistence	Hash check / backup / atomic authored writes / compile.	Conflicts block overwrite.
Permissions	Capability manifest for file, bridge, plugin and assistant.	Visible controls match actual support.
Cross-tool export	Selected roots + dependency closure + native payloads.	Missing dependencies listed or blocked.

Reference service

Resolve IDs with kind + scope, track usage, and attach provenance. Renames change labels; changing referenced IDs needs a migration. Graph edits and row edits share semantic validation.

Host boundary

Keep editor file API isolated from embedded game origin. Strict source/origin checks, nonce and request IDs for bridges. Existing local host guards are reused; an iframe alone proves nothing.

Remaining evidence gaps

Private Workshop and desktop Pose sources remain unverified. No phone gesture, engine outcome or live bridge has been tested by this design book. These gaps have testable acceptance boundaries.

Improvement path across every tool

Build the shared foundation, then apply it in workspace-sized slices with real validation.

Slice	Concrete result	Evidence required
1 / Foundation	Project context, numeric grammar, reference graph, history and capability API	Existing files round-trip; conflict and recovery verified
2 / Cards + decks	Readable inspection, explicit moves, synced document modes	Exact IDs/effects retained; touch/keyboard refusal tests
3 / Tags + ERD	Tree/graph/table links and staged 0.2.4 imports	Native v2/v3 fixtures; imported vs generated data checks
4 / Scene + UI + lab	External renderer host, responsive inspector and isolated sizing	All current settings retained; stage units and overflow shown
5 / Poses + effects	Shared timeline inspector, match reasons and format adapters	Deterministic bindings; no missing assets or timing loss
6 / Combat	Real runner integration and baseline receipt comparison	Snapshot, ruleset, seed and applied revision recorded
7 / Project finish	Scoped exports, assets, scripts/plugins and assistant handoff	Dependency closure, hashes, backups and compile validation

DONE MEANS

Each workspace opens existing data, edits supported fields, undoes safely, validates with its real owner, preserves unknown native data, and exports honestly. The shell is reusable; it does not replace the game engine or force a new interchange format.

Grounding

AshenSpire dev snapshot
38166cb12a2d8901fce7727aca37cd8d2e7e4b2d: editor, UI Studio, Pose & Effects, prologue, deck model, tag authoring and compilers.

ERD inspection

ERD-Workbench-v0.2.4.html: APP_VERSION line 8718; native export 8987; v2/v3 validation 8992 onward; imported rows around 9023; docking and edit/sync tools 780-871.

Deliverable status

16-page design book with precise static preview examples. No app code has been changed or deployed by this design task. Prior consolidated requirements remain valid except superseded ERD and shell assumptions.